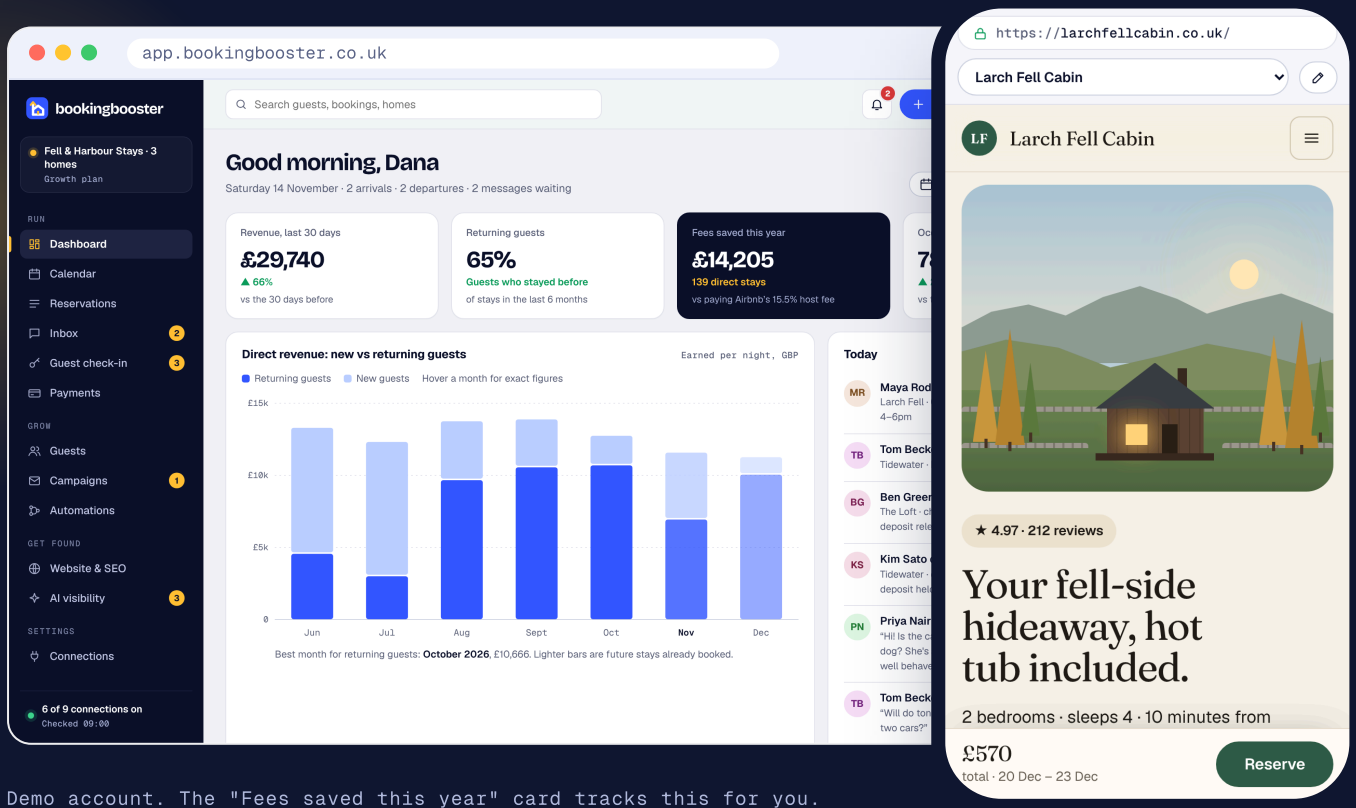
FREE WORKSHEET · 5 MINUTES

Find your fee leak.

Platform fees come out of every stay. Most hosts never add them up. Grab last year's payout report and a pen, and see what the leak costs you in a year.

1 WORKSHEET | 1 WORKED EXAMPLE | 5 WAYS TO PLUG IT



Demo account. The "Fees saved this year" card tracks this for you.

STEP BY STEP

Work out your leak

Use real numbers from your platform reports. Round to the nearest hundred. Rough is fine; you want the size of the leak, not a tax return.

A **Platform booking revenue, last 12 months**
Add up Airbnb, Booking.com and any other platform payouts, plus the fees they took. Your payout or earnings report has this.
£ _____

B **Your fee rate**
Host-only fee on Airbnb is about 15.5%. On a split-fee setup you pay about 3% and guests pay roughly 14% to 17% on top.
% _____

C **Fees you paid this year**
A × B. This is the leak.
£ _____

D **Guest service fees on top**
Split-fee listings only. A × about 14%. Money your guests spent that never reached you.
£ _____

E **Your direct booking goal**
Share of revenue you want to move to your own site. 20% to 50% is a common first-year target.
% _____

F **Fees you keep**
C × E
£ _____

G **Minus card processing on direct stays**
A × E × about 2%. Stripe and similar charge per payment; UK cards cost less, overseas cards more.
- £ _____

H **Minus your direct booking tools**
Monthly cost × 12. Example: Growth plan £119 × 12 = £1,428.
- £ _____

= **Estimated money kept per year**
F - G - H.
ESTIMATE ONLY
£ _____

Fee rates change by platform, country, listing settings and booking length. Check the current numbers in your own account. This worksheet gives an estimate, not a promise.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Example host: Dana, 3 holiday lets in the Lake District

An illustrative example with invented numbers, so you can see the math end to end. ESTIMATE ONLY

A. Platform revenue, 12 months	**£85,800**
B. Fee rate (host-only)	**15.5%**
C. Fees paid	**£13,299**
D. If split-fee, guests also paid about	**£12,012**

THE LEAK, PER YEAR

£13,299

About £1,108 a month, or £40 on every one of her 330 platform nights.

What she keeps at different direct shares

GOAL	F. FEES KEPT	G. CARD PROCESSING	H. GROWTH PLAN	NET PER YEAR
20% direct	£2,660	-£343	-£1,428	**£889**
35% direct	£4,655	-£601	-£1,428	**£2,626**
50% direct	£6,650	-£858	-£1,428	**£4,364**

At 35% direct



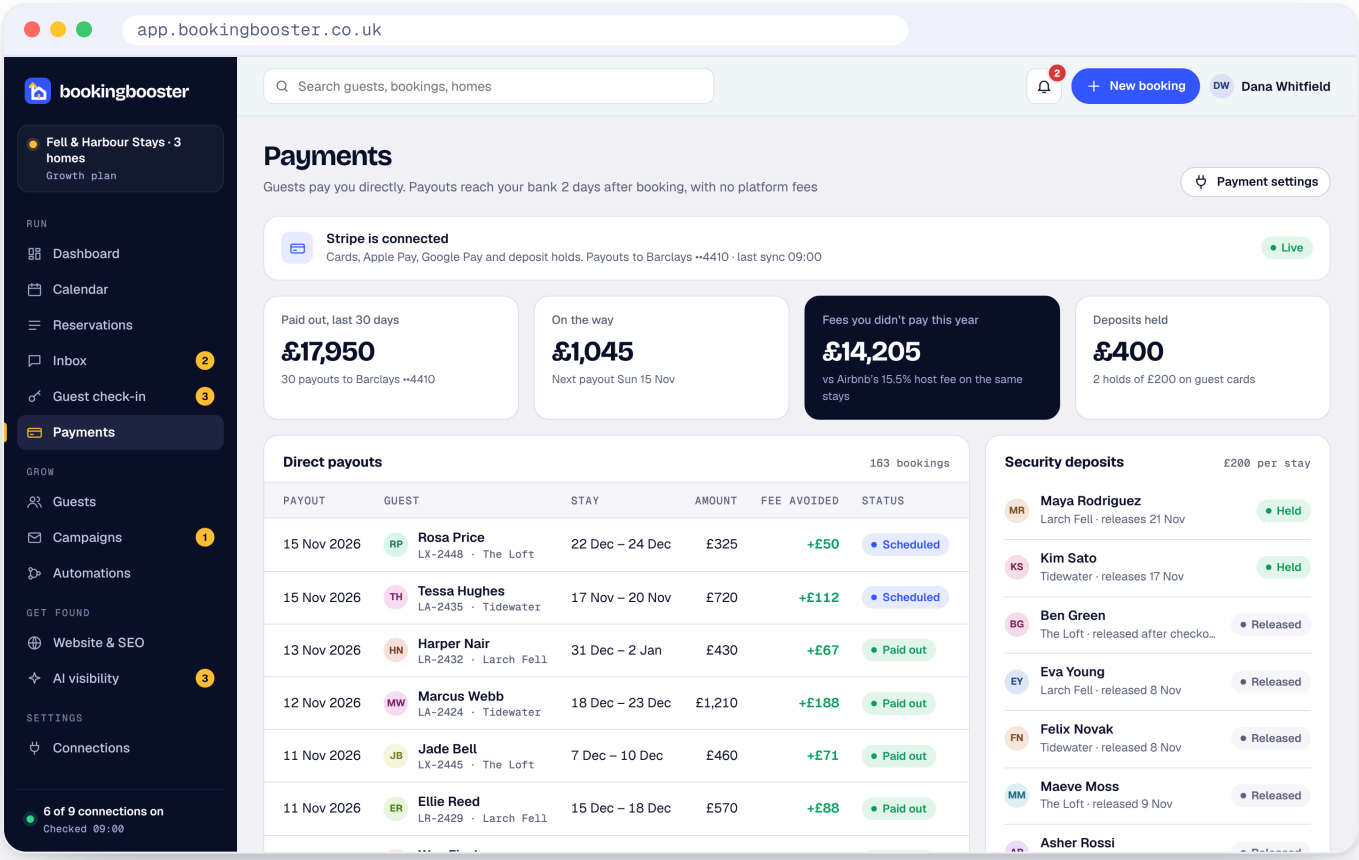
Read this right. At low direct shares the tools can cost more than they save. That is why the first job is getting found and bringing past guests back. Repeat guests who rebook direct cost nothing to win again, and the fee you skip grows with every stay.

Illustrative example. Dana is not a real customer. Card processing assumed at a blended 2%. Your fees, rates and results will differ.

PLUG THE LEAK

Five ways to keep more of every stay

- [ ] **Own a booking site on your own domain.** A real site with live dates and instant payment. Not a page that sends guests back to Airbnb.
- [ ] **Get found for the searches that matter.** Local pages for your town, your best features, and the questions travellers ask ChatGPT and Google.
- [ ] **Keep your guest list.** Every direct guest gives you their email and phone. Ask for consent to stay in touch.
- [ ] **Make coming back easy.** A thank-you note after checkout, a returning guest rate, and first pick of next season.
- [ ] **Price direct a little lower.** Guests skip a 14% to 17% service fee. You can share some of that and still keep more.



Demo account. Direct payouts land in your bank with no platform fee.

WANT THIS DONE FOR YOU?

Bookingbooster builds your direct booking site and sets it up for you in a week.

From £79/month. No setup fee. Cancel anytime. See your own numbers at bookingbooster.co.uk.